

QualiPharm GmbH — Site B (EU Operations)
STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE
EU GMP Complaint Handling — European Distribution Site

SOP Number	SOP-EU-GMP-001
Version	4.1
Effective Date	April 01, 2024
Review Date	April 01, 2026
Jurisdiction	EU — Site B (EudraLex Volume 4, ICH Q10)
Document Owner	EU Quality Operations
Approved By	EU Qualified Person (QP)
Classification	ACTIVE — Current Version
References	EudraLex Volume 4 Chapter 8, Annex 11

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the EU-specific requirements for the receipt, documentation, classification, investigation, and reporting of quality complaints for pharmaceutical products distributed from QualiPharm Site B within the European Economic Area (EEA). This procedure implements the requirements of EudraLex Volume 4 Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP) Guidelines, Chapter 8 — Complaints, Quality Defects and Product Recalls, with reference to Annex 11 (Computerised Systems) for electronic complaint management.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to:

- All medicinal products held in the Marketing Authorisation (MA) portfolio of QualiPharm GmbH distributed within the EU/EEA
- Complaints received from patients, healthcare professionals, national competent authorities, wholesalers, and parallel importers
- Quality defects and potential quality defects identified post-release
- All staff at Site B handling complaints: QA, Regulatory Affairs, Customer Service, Qualified Person

3. EU Regulatory References

Regulation / Guideline	Requirement
EudraLex Volume 4 Chapter 8	Complaints, quality defects, and product recalls. Written procedures for complaint management required.
EudraLex Volume 4 Annex 11	Computerised systems — electronic complaint records must meet data integrity requirements (ALCOA+).
Directive 2001/83/EC Article	Marketing authorisation holders must maintain a system for defect

117	reporting and recall.
ICH Q10 Section 3.2.3	Pharmaceutical Quality System requirement for complaint and adverse event management.
ICH Q9	Risk-based approach to complaint classification. Risk assessment must be documented.
Regulation (EC) No 726/2004	EU rapid alert system — serious quality defects must be reported to EMA and national competent authorities.

4. Complaint Receipt and Intake

All complaints must be received and recorded in the QualiTrace electronic complaint management system within 24 hours. The following fields are mandatory per EU GMP Chapter 8 requirements:

- `product_name` — full INN name, strength, and dosage form as per MA
- `batch_number` — EU batch number from label (must match MA batch records). If unavailable, set status = `pending_review`
- `market_code` — EU country code where product was dispensed/used
- `complaint_type` — classify as contamination, quality, or labeling
- `patient_impact` — true if adverse event reported or suspected
- `description` — verbatim complaint text

EU Rapid Alert Obligation (Chapter 8.17):

Complaints that may constitute a serious defect — defined as any defect that could result in a recall, or that requires notification to competent authorities — must be reported to the EU rapid alert system within 24 hours of the defect being identified. This applies to all critical complaints.

4.1 EU-Specific Classification Rules

In addition to the global classification rules in SOP-QA-001, the following EU-specific rules apply:

- **MULTILINGUAL LABELING:** Missing or incorrect language on label constitutes a medium risk labeling complaint minimum. If language omission could lead to incorrect use by patient, escalate to critical.
- **QP NOTIFICATION:** The EU Qualified Person (QP) must be notified of all critical and high risk complaints within 4 hours of classification.
- **MA NUMBER VERIFICATION:** Confirm the `batch_number` matches a batch certified by the QP under the EU Marketing Authorisation. Batches not matching MA records must be escalated to critical.
- **PARALLEL IMPORT CHECKS:** For complaints on parallel-imported products, determine if defect originated at EU Site B or at the source market. Document jurisdiction determination in investigation record.

4.2 Investigation Requirements — EU Chapter 8

Per EudraLex Volume 4 Chapter 8, investigations must:

1. Assess whether the quality defect is linked to a specific batch or batches
2. Retrieve retained samples from the EU retention sample program (minimum 2x full analysis quantity retained per EU GMP)
3. Review batch manufacturing and control records
4. Consider whether other batches or other products could be affected
5. Review post-market stability data where relevant (Annex 11 data integrity requirements apply)
6. Determine root cause using documented risk assessment methodology (ICH Q9 compliant)
7. Assess need for notification to national competent authorities and EMA

Investigation output must document:

- evidence_summary — summary of all evidence reviewed
- root_cause_hypotheses — minimum 3 hypotheses ranked by probability
- overall_confidence — confidence score 0.0 to 1.0 for primary hypothesis
- source_list — list of EU regulatory documents and SOPs referenced
- regulatory_reporting_required — boolean, with justification

5. CAPA Requirements — EU GMP

Per ICH Q10 and EudraLex Volume 4, CAPA actions for EU complaints must:

- Address both the immediate defect (corrective action) and the systemic root cause (preventive action)
- Reference the specific EudraLex chapter or ICH guideline that drives each action
- Include effectiveness criteria that can be measured and verified
- Be completed within timeframes aligned with risk_level: critical = 15 days, high = 30 days, medium = 60 days, low = 90 days
- Be reviewed and approved by the EU Qualified Person for critical and high risk cases

6. Record Retention — EU Requirements

Per EudraLex Volume 4 Chapter 8, complaint records must be retained for:

- Minimum 1 year beyond the expiry date of the batch concerned
- Minimum 5 years from the date of batch certification by the QP (whichever is longer)
- Electronic records must comply with Annex 11 data integrity (ALCOA+): Attributable, Legible, Contemporaneous, Original, Accurate, plus Complete, Consistent, Enduring, Available

7. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary
4.1	Apr 2024	EU QA / QP	Added parallel import classification rule. Updated Annex 11 data integrity references.
4.0	Jan 2023	EU QA	Full revision to align with revised EudraLex Volume 4 Chapter 8 (2022 update).

3.2	May 2021	EU QA	Added ICH Q10 CAPA effectiveness criteria requirements.
-----	----------	-------	---